DIVINE DEBUT



The first film in a new trilogy on Lord Krishna, *Krishnavataram*, has drawn much attention in Uttar Pradesh. Young actor **Sanskriti Patel**, granddaughter of current state governor **Anandiben Patel**, plays Satyabhama, one of the lord's beloved queens. The film was in the news after a special screening at Lok Bhavan in Lucknow on May 10, where CM Yogi Adityanath watched it with the governor and members of the cabinet. Soon after, the Yogi government gave the film tax-free status in UP. Sanskriti, incidentally, is an alumnus of the New York Film Academy.



The Outreach



Rajasthan CM **Bhajan Lal Sharma's** late-night review meetings, and his conspicuous presence at social and religious events have always made headlines. Now, his state tours also include night halts in villages where he holds on-the-spot grievance-redressal meetings and also goes on morning walks with villagers. What explains this latest attempt to reinforce his political image? Could it have anything to do with the growing chatter in BJP circles about a 'performance review' halfway through his tenure.

MAHA INTRIGUES



Speculation about Maharashtra deputy CM **Eknath Shinde's** 'Operation Tiger' to poach leaders from the rival Shiv Sena (UBT) has resurfaced after he met UBT Lok Sabha MP Sanjay Patil and his wife Pallavi following her accident. Meanwhile, the ruling Mahayuti alliance is also seeing some rumbling. After deputy CM **Sunetra Pawar's** impressive Baramati assembly bypoll win, son Jay Pawar is projecting her as a chief ministerial face for 2029. With the BJP's Devendra Fadnavis currently in the saddle and ex-CM Shinde still eyeing a comeback, another claimant in the mix has triggered some unease.

Kaushik Deka **with** ***Prasad Nichenametla, Jumana Shah, Ashish Misra, Rohit Parihar*** **and** ***Dhaval S. Kulkarni***

HEALTH WATCH

By **Sonali Acharjee**

THE HANTAVIRUS SCARE BEWARE OF THE RODENTS

What began as a mysterious illness aboard an Antarctic luxury cruise has now turned into one of the world's most closely watched infectious disease scares. The hantavirus outbreak, which left several passengers critically ill and caused multiple deaths, has drawn attention not only because the virus is rare, but because the Andes strain involved is one of the few known to show limited human-to-human transmission. Scientists and public-health agencies nevertheless stress that this is not a COVID-scale threat. The overall risk remains low.



Hantavirus is primarily spread through contact with infected rodent urine, saliva or droppings. Early symptoms can look deceptively ordinary—fever, bodyache, fatigue, headache and nausea—before some patients rapidly develop severe breathing difficulty and fluid build-up in the lungs, a condition known as Hantavirus Pulmonary Syndrome (HPS), which can be fatal. Health experts advise basic but important precautions: avoiding direct contact with rodent waste, ventilating closed rooms before cleaning them, using disinfectants instead of dry sweeping, and improving sanitation in storage and residential areas.

India has never seen a major hantavirus outbreak of its own, but the virus is not entirely unfamiliar either. Sporadic cases and evidence of exposure have been documented over the years, particularly among people working in possible rodent-infested places, such as warehouses or agri hubs. Indian authorities have already stepped up monitoring through ICMR labs after two Indian crew members aboard the affected ship tested positive. Both are asymptomatic, as of now.